DOWNTOWN

Sunday
October 11, 2026
THE HINDU

‘Shelter work at Guindy bus stop makes tardy progress’

Parking of vehicles makes it difficult for commuters to board buses





P. SENTHIL KUMAR

Without a shelter, the Guindy railway station bus stop on Race Course Road is extremely user-unfriendly.

The stop is meant for buses toward Velachery, Nanganallur, Porur, Poonamallee, Kundrathur, Tambaram and Kilambakkam.

Greater Chennai Corporation dismantled the shelter last year barely a week before the onset of north-east monsoon to provide a tensile roof.

Several months have gone by and the next rainy season is round the corner, and the work to provide the new roof is not complete still. The earlier shelter, despite being decades-old, was good providing adequate coverage. There were no complaints of water leakage. Therefore, commuters saw no need for a new one.

The main issue was beggars and destitute people occupying the seats and making the shelter their home. No measures were taken to address that issue.

This stop witnesses a good number of commuters, especially during peak hours as the stations of EMU sub-urban trains and metro trains are located near this bus stop. The Guindy Industrial estate is also nearby. Given the importance of the stop, Greater Chennai Corporation should get the new shelter ready at the earliest. It may be noted that the number of existing temporary shelters is not enough. Further, footpath relaying work is under way on Race Course Road. The stretch near the bus stop is uneven adding to the inconvenience.

Besides, GCC should consider setting up a shelter for the stop on the opposite side of the road. This stop is meant for buses towards T. Nagar and Royapuram. The stop never had a shelter. There is not even a signboard to indicate the spot to be a bus stop. Here, parking of two wheelers and autorickshaws makes it difficult for commuters to board buses.

P. Senthil Kumar is a resident of Iyyappanthanal



The Guindy bus stop on Race Course Road on October 7, 2026.

‘Improperly covered pits pose a threat’

VANITHA PAULCHAMY

A stretch of Arcot Road in Valasaravakkam, especially the section accounting for Keshvardhani Nagar bus stop, is unsafe for pedestrians.

Here, stormwater drain construction is going on. But that cannot be an excuse for compromising the safety of pedestrians.

The open manholes are carelessly covered with wooden boards. Some open sections of the drain which are under construction are not properly barricaded. This can pose a serious threat during rains. All these open pits which are improperly covered will not be noticed when the road gets inundated. Greater Chennai Corporation should attend to this issue without much delay as north-east monsoon is round the corner.

Vanitha Paulchamy is a resident of Saligramam

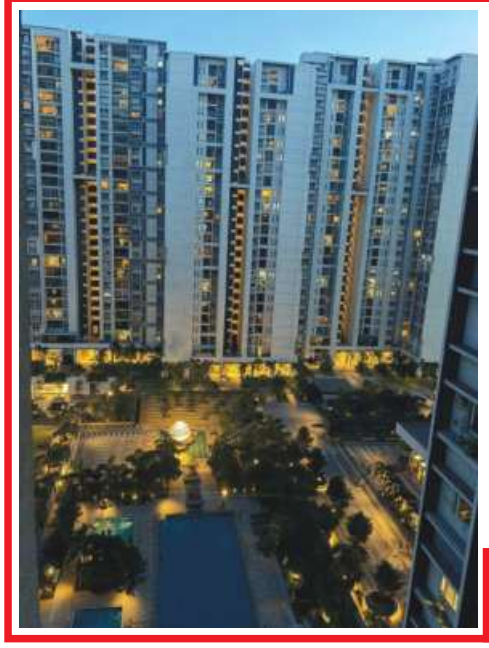






The Valasarawakkam stretch of Arcot Road near Keshavardhini bus stop on October 6, 2026.

FLAT FOR SALE



BAASHYAAM CROWN RESIDENCES

at Koyambedu.
3BHK + 3T with Private Terrace

Contact
80159 80357

‘Service lane near Porur Bypass metro rail station poses a threat’

MURUGESAN R

The pedestrian space at the service lane of Perungalathur-Puzhal Road via Maduravoyal Bypass near Porur tollgate is quite unsafe. Here, the stormwater drain doubles up as footpath. But the drain is broken and wide open in many spots. This can lead to untoward incidents.

It may be noted Porur Bypass metro railway station is located nearby. The arrangements made around the railway station in view of the inauguration are commendable. However, the service lane in the vicinity of the station poses a threat. This has been the case for the past several months. The lane witnesses heavy traffic. With the opening of the first stretch of CMRL’s Phase - Two, Poonamallee Bypass to Vadapalani, many will be using the service lane.

Hence the authorities should ensure the approach roads are safe.

Murugesan R is a resident of Porur



The service lane near Porur tollgate. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Protect SWD from encroachments’



Kamrajar Salai in K.K. Nagar.

S.N. RAJARAM

Stormwater drain construction is under way on Kamarajar Salai in K.K. Nagar. Greater Chennai Corporation should ensure that the new drain which will also double as the pedestrian space and that it is well maintained.

This road is known for encroachments.

The footpaths and margins of the road have been usurped. Eateries including juice shops and tea stalls keep their tables, water cans and bins on the footpath. Likewise, grocery stores find the pedestrian space convenient to keep its belongings such as tubs, baskets, mats and broomsticks. Further, the vehicles of customers of automobile repair shops, roadside vendors including pushcarts also occupy the footpath.

All these have compromised the safety of pedestrians on this road which witnesses heavy traffic. The road despite having a footpath witnesses pedestrians walking on the thoroughfare. Schools and staff quarters of Central government departments are located on this road.

Further, many stretches of the footpaths of this road were broken. This includes manholes of stormwater drains.

Now that GCC is revamping the stromwater drain on Kamarajar Salai, measures should also be taken to ensure encroachments do not impair their functioning.

It may be noted that Greater Chennai Corporation carried out a drive to remove encroachements a couple of years ago. But within a few hours, the encroachments were back.

S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam

‘Seized vehicles occupy footpath near Sivan Park’

A considerable space of P T Rajan Salai in K.K. Nagar (along Sivan park) is taken up by vehicles seized by the police.

They are lying here for months gathering dust. Among the vehicles are cars and autorickshaws.

The park witness a good number of visitors. Hence, its approach road should be well maintained.

In another section of PT Rajan salai, near Anugraha Apartment, telecommunication cables are lying low. Yet another hindrance is pipes occupying the footpath near the intersection of Rani Anna Nagar Main Road.







P.T. Rajan Salai on K.K. Nagar.

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@ thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.

THE HINDU GROUP

SHOW YOUR KOLU AT OUR CITY'S BIGGEST KONDATTAM.

This Navarathri, Chennai comes alive with the magic of your Kolu.
Upload a picture of your Kolu and win exciting prizes.

Don't miss our city's grandest showcase of creativity and culture.

Scan or visit **fline.news/MOCKL2026PA** to upload your Kolu pictures.

Last day to participate: October 15, 2026

For queries please contact:
90030 77030, 81487 48183



GOPURAM
TURMERIC POWDER • KUMKUM

Presents

Made Of Chennai KOLU KONDATTAM
THE HINDU DOWNTOWN

Upload a picture of your kolu arrangement featuring packs of **ITC Mangaldeep and Dheepam** products to earn extra points.

Powered by

DHEEPAM LAMP OIL | MANGALDEEP PREMIUM QUALITY INCENSE | PRINCE JEWELLERY

In Association with

POORVIKA APPLIANCES

T&C apply*

Associate Partners: NARPAVI | RMKV | Sundari Silks | Tasty Tasty

Banking Partner: pnb

Food Partner: Cafe Coffee House

Venue Partner: VELS

Water Partner: repute

Gift Partners: Cotton House | Dfa | Hanbao | hilaptop.com | Maestro | Medimix | naga | RAS Chekku Oil | Vivekanandha

Prepare for the rainy day

The wholesalers and retailers in this specific trade might be scattered, but George Town is still the place to visit ahead of the monsoon to stock up on rainwear and winterwear. Two legacy enterprises illustrate why this is Chennai's rainwear hub

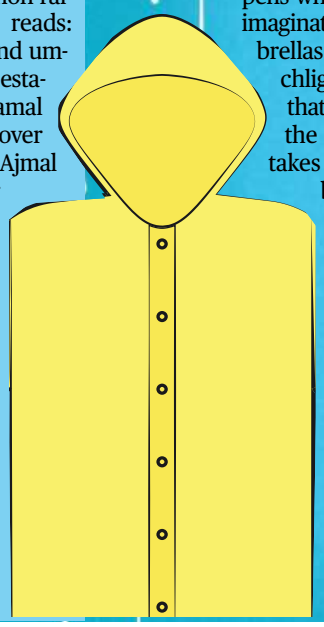
LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

In George Town, trades have a vice-like grip on streets, owning them to the point of suffocation. Every street name board bears an unwritten promise to meet an overwhelming existential need. If bags are your ticket to retail therapy, head to Stringer Street. Seeking to announce a new life chapter with the printing of a wedding card? Anderson Street holds out an invitation to you to visit it. Want to indulge your sartorial addiction? Saunter into Godown Street. Looking to be stocked up on rainwear ahead of the monsoon? No pat answer there; that requires the directory of George Town to be consulted.

Rainwear shopping in George Town is spatially undefined, but George Town is the best place in town to scour for it. Wholesalers and retailers of raincoats and umbrellas and woollen winterwear (you read that right, exclusive winter wear shopping in Chennai) are scattered across the landscape. They are found on NSC Bose Road, separated by shops ruled by other trades; on Malayaperumal Street and Rattan Bazaar Road. The term "raingear" presupposes seasonality; and the enterprises, both wholesale and retail, pair them with an all-season product or two to keep the cash register ringing through the year.

On Malayaperumal Street, New Jothi Stores LLP does this kind of pairing to stay afloat on a non-rainy day. The product line reads: bags, luggages, raincoats and umbrellas. The enterprise was established in 1968 by Hajji Jamal Mohideen, who handed over the baton to his sons, Hajji Ajmal Khan and Hajji Mujibur Rahman. And the baton is now lodged with the founder's grandsons, Muhammed Mohideen and his cousin Muhammed Sirajudeen. The store at George Town boasts massive square-footage, and is present in other locations, not as outlets but manufacturing units. There is a unit in Mint Street, another in Athipet and two others in Maharashtra, each one dedicated to the manufacture of specific product. In addition, there is sourcing from elsewhere which includes importing. The shelves at New Jothi Stores offer a glimpse of what happens when necessity meets a little imagination. From traditional umbrellas to reversible ones, torchlight umbrellas and designs that change colour when wet, the shop's promise of variety takes centre stage. While the bags and luggages segment is on an even keel through the year, the one involving raincoats and umbrellas wax and wane depending on the monsoon and its intensity. Copious rains means brisk business. But New Jothi Stores does not chase only the North East Monsoon for business, but the South West Monsoon as well. As a wholesaler, its brings Kerala and Karnataka into the picture supplying raincoats and umbrellas to retailers out there, and what emerges is a semblance of an all-year business.

Besides, with a touch of creativity and customisation, a seasonal project such as the umbrella is made attractive when the skies are clear. Mohideen points out that umbrellas made in the colours of a political party are a hit through the year. So, there are umbrellas that cover all parties on the political spectrum, enabling party cadres to display their allegiance.



Shopping spots

Streets close to Flower Bazaar sport shops selling monsoon kit, NSC Bose Road has a number of them including Ebrahim Currim & Sons, the iconic manufatiurer and seller of Stag umbrellas. There is MS Rahim Stores for raincoats. On Malayaperumal Street, there is New Jothi Stores. On Mangammal Street, there is Hindustan Industries. On Rattan Bazaar Road, there is Joonus Sait & Sons.

Where 'winter' never ends

All through the year, winter hovers over one address at Ratan Bazaar Road in George Town. Joonus Sait & Sons, established in 1905, sells rainwear and woollen winterwear in good old, often searing-hot Chennai, operating in bustling Ratan Bazaar. The patriarch of the family, Usman Sait defends the decision taken by his forbear several "winters" ago and followed by successive generations. The winterwear is not just for those navigating a narrow band of winter months in Chennai, but also for those travelling abroad to coordinates where winter defines the climate more than any other season. In a globalised economy, a massive number of people go abroad for studies and work and vacations (and of course, there are also cooler places in India to travel to), remarks Usman, and they know "there is a Joonus Sait & Sons". That confidence bordering on chutzpah has worked for the family and the business, which has put out branches, one in Purasaiwalkam and another in Adyar. Usman manages the legacy enterprise with the support of his wife Zulekha and sons Naumaan Sait and Safwaan Sait.

The enterprise's service extends to helping customers choose according to their destination and travel duration and also educating them on preserving the items. Bulk order for corporate clients is a strong feature of the business. Its woollen wear, including brands such as Monte Carlo, are sourced from Ludhiana. For Usman, the store is also a childhood memory. He recalls accompanying his father after school, wondering why he had to spend the afternoon there. The lessons he absorbed however became his own principles, passed down to his sons. Legacy is the operative word. Usman speaks wistfully of the golden days when his father was his mentor in the trade. He speaks with equal fondness of the here and now, with a special softness reserved for his four granddaughters, who visit the store and learn the business from him. He adds that they will take the legacy forward. Usman's son Naumaan notes that the enterprise treats every client as a part of the legacy.

Calls for new transformers intensify

LIFFY THOMAS

For Bilkhis Sait, "overload", "changeover" and "low voltage" are everyday terminology. A resident of Marshalls Road in Egmore for the last three decades, Bilkhis notes unscheduled power cuts have become a daily feature in her locality.

"Sometimes, the outage lasts a few hours. At times power goes off in all the three phases," says Bilkhis.

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) technicians do attend to complaints raised through the helpline number. "They replace the cable and power is restored but the same issue resurfaces. We have not got a long-term solution," says the French language trainer who wants the transformer in the neighbourhood upgraded.

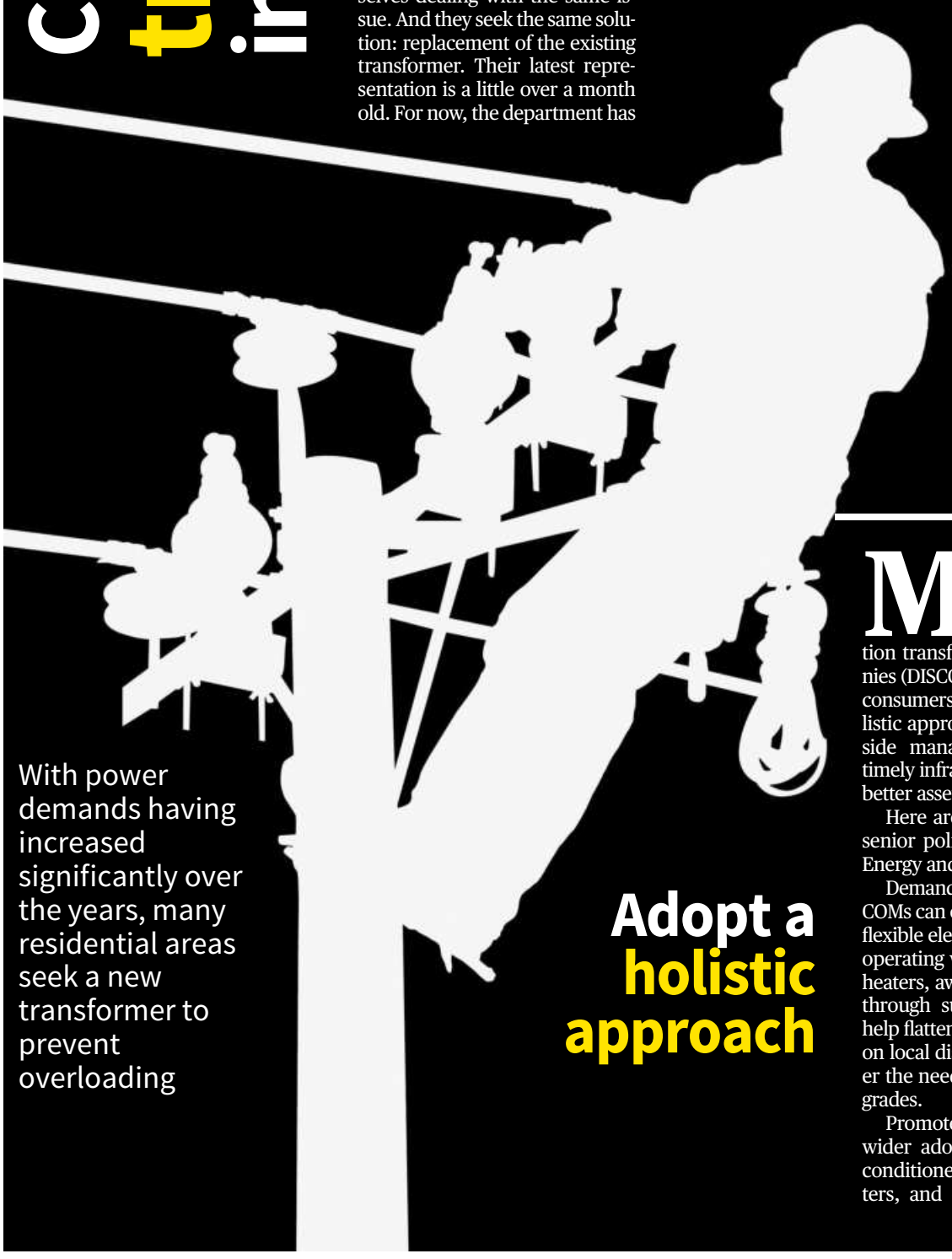
Residents of Tarapore Avenue in Harrington Road find themselves dealing with the same issue. And they seek the same solution: replacement of the existing transformer. Their latest representation is a little over a month old. For now, the department has provided thicker wires so the frequent power outages have almost reduced.

With independent houses giving way to apartment complexes and commercial buildings in many areas, the rusty transformer is not able to take the load anymore. Increasing power demands from houses and offices using heavy electrical appliances, and climate change are adding to the stress on the neighbourhood distribution transformers.

So, how is TNPDCL addressing the increasing electricity demand and growing renewable energy penetration?

Upgrading the load capacity of an existing transformer, adding new transformers and bifurcating the load supply are some common measures initiated by the electricity department, taken after many assessments and calculations.

In Chennai's residential areas, distribution transformers generally have a load capacity of 100 kVA, 250 kVA and 500 kVA, depending on the number of people the utility is catering to. But rising load is one of the major reasons for transformers failing.



With power demands having increased significantly over the years, many residential areas seek a new transformer to prevent overloading

Help at hand

Raise a complaint on Minnagam (9498794987) mentioning the frequency of power cuts or other load-related complaints

Write to the respective distribution region in your area seeking a review of the power load. Their contact numbers and mail IDs are on the website https://www.tnpdcl.org/en/tnpdcl/ reach-us/contact-information

Excess load?

According to officials, transformers have an average lifespan of 20 years but this could vary depending on how well they are maintained. Factors such as natural calamities, manufacturing defects, ageing, short circuits and other unexpected reasons would require these electrical equipments to be replaced more often. Many defunct transformers have to be replaced because of overload and lighting.

TNPDCL is expected to assess areas where complaints are common and initiate improvement measures. A consumer may not know the capacity of the transformer or the distribution network, so the executive engineer for the area should be first informed about such power-related complaints. The engineer has to justify the electricity needs and suggest whether it can do with an upgrade or a new utility transformer is required.

"As the load pattern is different in the morning and evening, the transformer load is measured by our field staff based on a set of parameters. When the transformer reaches more than 80% load then we decide on an upgrade or a new set up, which is done through a measuring tool. Electricity feeders are also remotely monitored by the control centre," says a senior engineer.

TNPDCL field staff prepares and submits an estimate of areas needing a new transformer, almost every month, to submit it to the head office for approval. The time to process a tender is usually three to four months.

Getting ROW clearance

A senior official says one of the biggest hurdles they face is getting right of way (ROW) clearance or permission to instal an electricity transformer in an area.

"Nobody wants a transformer in front of their house or the stay resting on their premises, so this delays the process. We scout for a public space as maintenance work can be taken up easily at such spots," says the official.

The Superintendent Engineer has the power to sanction a transformer. "If a transformer is badly needed in an area then in two-three months time it is sanctioned," says the official.

The "citizen charter" also insists that if the work involves placing or shifting a transformer structure then 90 days is the timeline followed as per the standards of performance for electricity distribution.

Adopt a holistic approach

Meeting the growing electricity demand of households requires more than just upgrading distribution transformers. Distribution companies (DISCOMs) that supply electricity to consumers in a state need to adopt a holistic approach that combines demand-side management, energy efficiency, timely infrastructure augmentation, and better asset management.

Here are suggestions by Rishu Garg, senior policy specialist working in the Energy and Power sector at CSTEP.

Demand-response programmes: DISCOMs can encourage households to shift flexible electricity consumption, such as operating washing machines and water heaters, away from peak-demand hours through suitable incentives. This can help flatten peak demand, ease pressure on local distribution networks, and defer the need for some infrastructure upgrades.

Promote energy-efficient appliances: wider adoption of energy-efficient air conditioners, refrigerators, water heaters, and other household appliances can reduce overall electricity consumption and limit the growth of peak demand. Targeted incentives, consumer awareness, and easier access to efficient appliances can help accelerate adoption.

Strengthen distribution infrastructure and expedite transformer upgrades: DISCOMs should make effective use of schemes such as the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS) to augment distribution infrastructure in areas experiencing rapid growth in household demand. Equally important are streamlined approval processes, clear timelines, and proactive identification of overloaded distribution transformers to ensure that capacity upgrades are completed before they become critical. However, this should be done after conducting feasibility studies based on load growth.

Adopt distribution asset lifecycle management systems: DISCOMs should invest in digital systems to monitor transformer loading, asset health, maintenance requirements, and failure risks.

Women receive ‘Golden Wings’

An initiative by Chennai-based Care Earth Trust is training local women in Vedanthangal and Unamancheri to identify birds, lead nature walks and earn a livelihood while spreading biodiversity awareness

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Until recently, for some of the women living around Vedanthangal, the birds they saw every day were simply part of the landscape. Today, they are part of their life, even the sounds of these avians being familiar to these women’s now-trained ears. That transformation was engineered by a nature-guide training programme from Chennai-based Care Earth Trust.

With the two-fold objective of increasing biodiversity awareness and providing livelihood opportunities, the programme began with women and young people from around Vedanthangal, training them in bird identification, wetland ecology, identification of trees butterflies, and communication skills. After months of classroom lessons and practical sessions, a group of eight trained participants have come together as ‘Golden Wings’ and are now conducting guided walks at Vedanthangal.

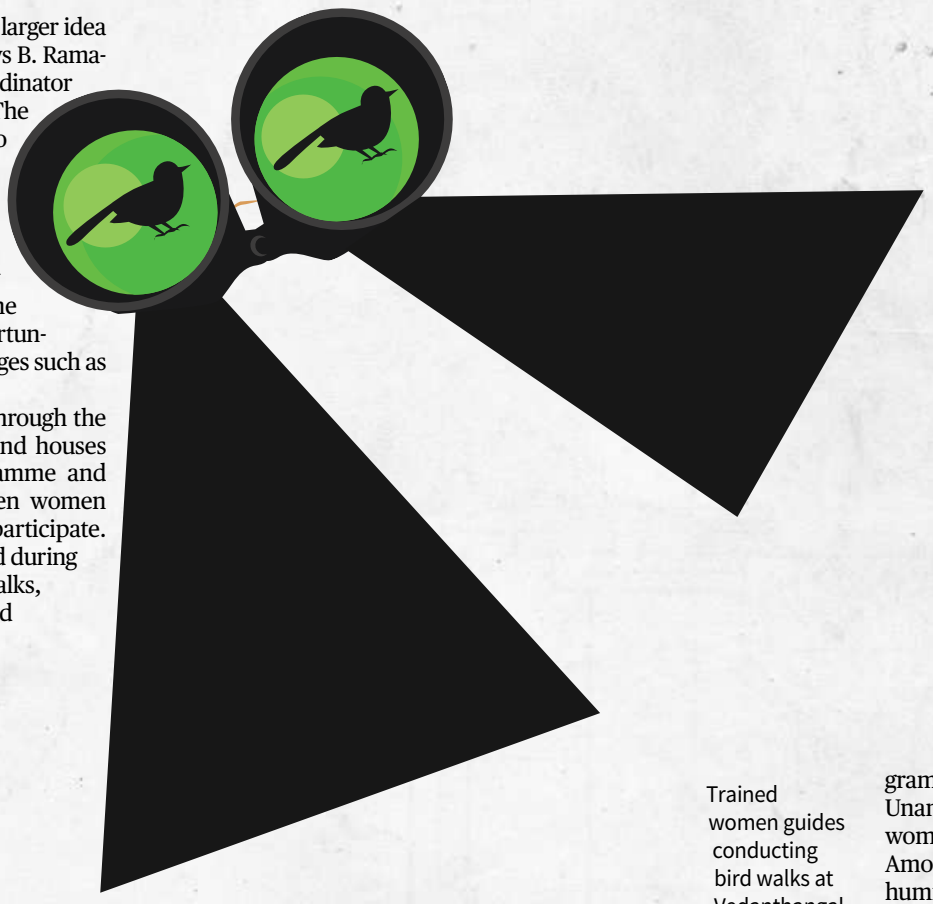
Vedanthangal resident S. Kalaiselvi Srinivasan, now a Golden Wings guide, says the work has given her an income opportunity as well as improved her communication skills.

For Subathirai D, however, the journey began with skepticism from those around her. When she first started attending the training, women in her neighbourhood questioned why she was spending her time on it. To them, learning about birds and nature seemed unnecessary, especially when she could be spending that time on household responsibilities or other work. But that perception began to change when Subathirai returned from the training and started earning through nature walks.

This is precisely the larger idea behind the project, says B. Ramamoorthy, Project Coordinator at Care Earth Trust. The organisation wanted to address two issues at once: the limited awareness among local communities about the biodiversity around them and the lack of livelihood opportunities for women in villages such as Vedanthangal.

The team worked through the panchayat, went around houses to explain the programme and spoke to families when women were hesitant to participate. Childcare was arranged during training and nature walks, food was provided, and the women themselves suggested Sundays as the most convenient day for classes.

The initial training involved classroom sessions using colour printouts and presentations to teach the participants about different birds, trees and butterflies. They then moved to practical walks, where they learnt to identify birds through their appearance and calls and understand local and native trees and their uses. They were also taken on a week-long exposure visit to Thattekad in Kerala to learn about forest biodiversity and migratory birds. The training did not stop with bird identification. The women were taught spoken English, people management and social-media skills.



Trained women guides conducting bird walks at Vedanthangal.

For Anjana Venkatesan, Programme Manager - Policy Research at Care Earth Trust, the project is about creating a connection between local women and the ecotourism circuit while drawing attention to the biodiversity outside Chennai. “Connecting them to the local kind of ecotourism circuit is a win-win for both of us,” she said. She also wants to challenge the perception that people have to travel to the Western Ghats to experience rich bird diversity. “Right in the outskirts of Chennai, you have these pockets with our existing forests and existing wetlands,” she said, adding that some of these areas record around 70 bird species during the migratory season.

The next phase of the programme is now taking shape in Unamancheri, Vandalur, where women are undergoing training. Among them is 29-year-old Madhumitha S., a B.Sc graduate who works in medical coding. Originally from Medavakkam, she moved to Unamancheri after marriage and has been attending the Sunday classes for around two months.

For Madhumitha, the training has meant discovering a side of the place she now calls home. Before joining the programme, she was familiar mainly with common birds. The classes introduced her to a much wider range of birds, trees, butterflies and other species.

Madhumitha is now learning how to handle tourists, engage them and conduct nature walks. She plans to continue her medical-coding job during the week and take up nature walks on weekends after completing her training.

Gathering at MMA treated to insightful conversation

The Madras Management Association (MMA), in association with TimeLinks and Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung, organised a special programme titled "Beyond the Hurdles - The Champion's Mindset for Leadership Excellence" at the MMA Management Center on Pathari Road in Thousand Lights, celebrating the outstanding achievements of Indian Olympian and Asian Games medallist Vithya Ramraj.

The highlight of the evening was an engaging conversation between Vithya Ramraj and Indian table tennis legend and Padma Shri awardee Achanta Sharath Kamal, who explored the mindset, discipline and resilience behind sustained excellence in competitive sport.

The programme sought to draw meaningful parallels between sporting excellence and leadership in business and management, says a press release.

At the recently concluded Asian Games in Nagoya, Vithya created history by clocking 54.75 seconds in the women's 400m hurdles, setting a new Indian national record and surpassing the iconic benchmark established by P. T. Usha at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics. She also won gold in the women's 4×400m relay, silver in the mixed 4×400m relay and bronze in the 400m hurdles.



Property expo in Pallavaram, Urapakkam

Today is the final day of ARK Eventz Property Expo 2026. The event is being held at Arul Murugan Towers, 200 Feet Radial Road, Old Pallavaram, and at Swapna Thirumana Mandapam, GST Road, Urapakkam; 10 a.m. to 7 p.m.

At the expo, prospective buyers can explore a wide range of property options, including apartments, villas, plots, and investment opportunities. Buyers can meet builders and developers, compare properties, and discover attractive options, said a release.

For registration and details, visit www.arkeventz.com or call 94444 56087.

Velammal Nexus felicitates Vithya Ramraj, Nehpal Singh



Velammal Nexus felicitated athlete Vithya Ramraj, who bagged three medals at the Asian Games, and her coach, Nehpal Singh. The felicitation ceremony was hosted by Velammal Vidyalaya in Avadi.

Vithya Ramraj, her mother Meena, and Nephal Singh were welcomed with a beautifully decorated chariot procession, flower garlands, and traditional ceremonial honours, creating an atmosphere of pride and celebration across the campus. As a mark of appreciation, Velammal Nexus presented a car each to Vithya Ramraj and Nephal Singh, said a release.

M.V. M. Velmohan, correspondent, Velammal Nexus, took part. Vithya's journey from rigorous training to winning medals at the Asian Games inspires thousands of young students aspiring to excel in sports, added the release.

Charging station in Poonamallee

Zappang Charging Stations has opened an electric vehicle (EV) charging station at Motel Highway in Poonamallee.

The station features a 60 kW DC fast-charging facility, designed to provide convenient charging for EV users. Focused on clean energy and sustainable transportation, Zappang aims to make EV charging more accessible for motorists. The facility promotes a greener driving experience and encourages the transition towards environmentally friendly mobility solutions.

For location details and inquiries, contact 95666 83952.

Navaratri music series till October 20

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan is conducting Navaratri music series under Saroja Parasaran Memorial Endowment from October 11 to October 20 at Bhavan's Main Hall in Mylapore. Two concerts are scheduled every day at 5 p.m. and at 6.30 p.m.

The programmes are open to all.

MOP Vaishnav College gives cash awards to sports stars



M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women recently felicitated the sports stars who performed well at the recently concluded Asian Games, and other international sports tournaments.

Aadhav Arjuna, Tamil Nadu Minister for Public Works and Sports Development, who was the chief guest, hailed the medallists as role models.

MOP students, former and current, who did well at the Asian Games in Japan and were felicitated: Baranica E (bronze in pole vault), Abinaya R (bronze in 4x100m mixed relay), Nandhini K (sixth in 100m H).

Other champions felicitated at the event included Savitha Shri B (individual gold in chess Olympiad in Samarkand) and Pooja Arthi R (silver in FISU World University Championship Mumbai).

The college management awarded each of the sportswomen a cash prize of ₹1 lakh in recognition of their achievement.









To advertise in
DOWNTOWN
Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787







Challani Jewellery exhibition open today at Taj Connemara

Challani Jewellery Mart's Challani's Jewelverse –Season 1, a grand showcase of exquisite jewellery, commenced on October 9 at Taj Connemara, under the leadership of Jayanthilal Challani, founder and chairman of Challani Jewellery Mart.

The exhibition was inaugurated by Adityaram, founder and chairman of the Adityaram Group who formally opened the event by cutting the ribbon and lighting the traditional ceremonial lamp.

According to a press release, the exhibition brings together an extensive collection of fine jewellery, featuring gold, diamonds, Polki, rose-cut diamonds and coloured gemstones under one roof. Combining traditional craftsmanship with contemporary designs, the showcase offers visitors an opportunity to explore a diverse range of distinctive jewellery collections.

Speaking to the media after the inauguration, Adityaram expressed his appreciation for the collection on display. "I have visited several jewellery exhibitions, but the variety of collections showcased here is truly remarkable. What stands out is the range of designs available not only for women but also for men, with distinctive pieces that are visually appealing," he said.

Jayanthilal Challani said although Challani Jewellery Mart has several branches, our objective is to bring different categories of jewellery together in one place, offering customers a comprehensive shopping experience. This exhibition features an exclusive selection of gold, diamond, Polki, rose-cut and coloured gemstone jewellery.

The inaugural event witnessed the participation of several prominent personalities, including Thangamalar Jagannath and Dr. Vimala Rani Britto, along with other distinguished guests and jewellery enthusiasts. Visitors were seen exploring the collections with considerable interest.

Challani's Jewelverse - Season 1 is being held from October 9 to 11 (between 10:00 a.m. and 9:00 p.m.)

Venue: Taj Connemara, Binny Road, Near Spencer Plaza

CM launches 'Dream Olympics'



Ishari K. Ganesh, president, Tamil Nadu Olympic Association, and founder-chancellor, Vels University, welcomed C. Joseph Vijay, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, at The Leela Palace recently.

The CM launched the 'Dream Olympics' initiative and felicitated Tamil Nadu's Asian Games and chess olympiad medal winners at the event organised by Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT).

Aadhav Arjuna, State Minister for Sports Development, and prominent sportspersons were among those who took part in the event.

New interior design showroom in city



Elevate and Bay Window, a customised home interior designing firm, has opened their showroom in Chennai.

According to a press release, Elevate focuses on bespoke modular kitchens and wardrobes with premium finishes, from matte and high-gloss lacquers to natural veneers, lacquered glass and laminates.

Bay Window offers furniture that blend international aesthetics with Indian sensibilities, across its signature collections: Modern Vogue, Scandi Minimalist, Ethnic Chic and the Luxe Edit, adds the press release.

The showroom is led by D S Shyam Sundar and Lakshmi Shyam Sundar, who have fronted the brands in Chennai for the past nine years – a record of projects successfully delivered across the city that laid the foundation for this launch, adds the release.

Impressive performance by Saveetha college students in sports meet



Saveetha Dental College Sports Club participated in ALTIUS'26, an intercollegiate medical and dental sports meet, organised by Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education & Research in Porur recently.

According to a press release, Saveetha Dental College team delivered an impressive performance. students won silver, gold, and bronze in the long jump. The college also won the volleyball tournament, adds the release.

In cricket, a student of the college won the "best bowler" title.

The kho kho team of Saveetha Dental College Sports Club securing the runner-up place in De Sportivous 4.0, another inter-college sports event, organized by Saveetha College of Occupational Therapy, held recently at Saveetha Medical College, Thandalam.

The teams were appreciated by the chancellor of Saveetha University, Dr. N. M Veeraiyan, adds the press release.

Clown festival concludes today

Today is the last day of the International Clown Festival 2026 happening at Sir Mutha auditorium in Chetpet with shows scheduled at 3 p.m. and 7 p.m. The International Clown Festival is a celebration of the universal language of laughter, bringing together the art and craft of professional clowning with the energy of live theatre. Designed as a family-friendly experience, the festival combines visual comedy, physical performance, music, juggling, and audience interaction to create a show that can be enjoyed by children and adults alike, said a press release.

The festival is curated and produced by Martin Flubber D'Souza, an award-winning international clown, former Vice President of the World Clown Association, and recipient of the International Clown of the Year award.

